therefore, any territory—whether Israel or Spain's al-Andalus—that has ever been under the rule of Islam must remain irreversibly under its sovereignty, as a *waqf*, or religious endowment held in trust for Allah as part of *Dar al-Islam*. Originally, Arab nationalists wanted to end the Ottoman domination of Arab lands. Then, after the Ottoman Empire was dissolved in 1918, they sought the end of a Western presence in the Arab world. Fundamentalists, however, wanted much more—the ultimate restoration of the Caliphate. The Zionist project was first viewed as a continuation of the Western presence. Then, both nationalists and Arab fundamentalists under the influence of Marxism, Leninism, fascism, and National Socialism started describing Zionism as "imperialist" and "colonialist," or as part of an alleged "world Jewish conspiracy." They still see it that way today.

Radical Islam is simply not compatible with Zionism. Militant Muslims are outspoken about wanting to destroy all that is not radical Islam. They are ready to kill all those who do not submit to it, as can be seen now in the "Islamic State" in Iraq and Syria, in the Hamas Charter, and in groups such as Boko Haram. In such conditions, Zionism would seem to have no chance of succeeding. Yet succeed it did—despite unbelievable adversity and despite the cowardice as well as the opportunism of Western leaders. Although Britain was granted a mandate over Palestine in 1922 with the clear objective of supporting the Jews, they never respected the spirit or the letter of the League of Nations Mandate. They gradually closed the doors to Jewish immigrants who were trying to flee Hitler's Europe before, during, and after World War II. The British government did not even try to save Jews at the time when the extermination was taking place in Auschwitz; and no member of the League of Nations issued any formal objection to British behavior.[12]

In parallel, the British kept the doors wide open to Arab immigration. In 1939, the British government issued the White Paper of 1939, providing for the creation of an "independent Palestine" to be governed by "Palestinian Arabs and Jews" in "proportion to their numbers in the population." The result of the British immigration policy was that Jews would remain a minority, and "Palestine" would become an Arab Muslim state. Despite early British complicity with Amin al-Husseini, an Islamic nationalist, violent antisemite, and friend of Adolf Hitler, Zionism still succeeded. Husseini, thanks to the approval of the British authorities, had been appointed Mufti of Jerusalem in 1921. But in order to be able to appoint him, the British High Commissioner, Sir Herbert Samuel, first had to pardon Husseini for having incited anti-Jewish riots in 1920. The British also chose Husseini despite his having received, in the election for Mufti, the least number of votes.[13]

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